

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a Hong Kong magazine:

An interview with music producer Mark Lui

Do you think the Hong Kong music scene is getting better or worse?

I would have to say that the industry is getting worse. The younger generation lacks hunger and the drive to be a superstar. I also don't see any new composers trying to do anything innovative. People seem content to just turn out the same old formulae again and again.



What do you think about our upcoming artists?

The talent is higher but the motivation is lower, which is a pity. Artists these days aren't hungry enough. They just want to do music because it's fun and cool.

Why do you feel young people aren't hungry enough?

I think these days life is too easy for them. They get everything they want from their parents. They often have helpers and grandparents carrying bags and doing everything for them.

Do you think we can change this?

It will be very difficult. The schools are not strict enough and so students don't learn the importance of hard work. Stars like Jacky Chan spent years and years working hard every day to develop their talent. Now young people think it is enough to have a cool haircut and the latest fashions.

What advice would you give to young people wanting to join the music scene?

They need to put down their phones and realise that if they have talent it needs to be developed and the only way to do that is hard work and practice.

A number of famous people in Hong Kong, such as Mark Lui, have recently criticised the young generation. Your group is meeting to discuss this issue. You may want to talk about:

- why older people criticise the younger generation
- whether you think the criticism is fair
- what is the biggest challenge for young people nowadays
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you think young people are hard working?
2. Do you think young people have an easy life?
3. Are young people today given too much help?
4. Do you think the younger generation are talented?
5. Why is it hard for the older generation to understand the young?
6. Do teachers and parents understand the challenges younger people face?
7. Would you prefer to be a teenager today or a teenager in the past?
8. How can the older generation better support the younger generation?